

- Backup on GitHub

OpenClaw

Protect your agent's memory · via chat or terminal

Why back up?

Your agent lives in the workspace files. If the server loses data, it loses its memory. GitHub is the vault: free, versioned, and accessible from anywhere.

- MEMORY.md

agent's memory

·

- Workspace

local files

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- GitHub

versioned backup

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- Safe

always recoverable

1 · Using via agent (main mode)

Most people don't need to use the terminal. Just send a message to the agent via

- Telegram

- WhatsApp

- Discord

- Get the GitHub authentication token

- PROMPT

Help me create a Personal Access Token on GitHub so I can configure the workspace backup

- PROMPT

Open GitHub in the browser on the token creation page for me

The agent will guide you through the process. After you create the token, save it securely (it only appears once).

- Configure the backup repository

- PROMPT

Create a private repository on GitHub called "openclaw-backup" and configure the workspace to push there. My token is [paste the token here]

- PROMPT

Initialize git in the workspace and connect it to my repository

github.com/meuuser/openclaw-backup

- Back up now

- PROMPT

Back up the workspace now · commit everything and send it to GitHub

- PROMPT

Commit the workspace changes with the message "manual backup 11/03" and push

- PROMPT

What was the last commit in the workspace? Is everything on GitHub?

- Create daily automatic backup cron

- PROMPT · DAILY CRON AT MIDNIGHT

Create a cron to automatically back up the workspace every day at midnight · commit everything and send it to GitHub

· PROMPT · CUSTOM SCHEDULE

Set up automatic backup every day at 11 PM Brasília time ·

git commit and push to GitHub, and notify me on Telegram when done

· PROMPT · CHECK ACTIVE CRONS

Which backup crons are running? List all scheduled backup jobs for me

· PROMPT · DISABLE CRON

Cancel the automatic GitHub backup cron

· Restore backup

· PROMPT

Show me the last 10 commits from the GitHub backup with date and message

· PROMPT

Restore the workspace to yesterday's 11 PM commit · I need to recover a file I deleted

· PROMPT

What has changed in the workspace since the last backup?

2 · How to create the Personal Access Token (PAT)

The token appears only once. Copy and save it in a secure location (e.g. 1Password) before closing the page.

1Access:

github.com/

settings/tokens/

new

(or GitHub · Settings · Developer settings ·

Personal access tokens · Tokens classic)

2 Note: give it a descriptive name, e.g.: openclaw-backup-vps

3 Expiration: I recommend No expiration (or 1 year if you prefer to renew)

4 Scopes· check only:

5 ·repo· full access to repos (includes private ones)

6 ·workflow· if you want to automate

GitHub Actions

7 Click Generate token · copy the generated token (starts with ghp_...)

8 Save in 1Password or pass it to the agent to save via prompt

Saving the token with the agent

· PROMPT

Save this GitHub token in 1Password with the name "GitHub PAT

- OpenClaw Backup": ghp_XXXXXXXXXXXX

· Never do this

Don't commit the token in any repo file

Don't paste the token in group messages

Don't leave it in .env or loose text files

·

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3 · Manual setup via terminal (admins)

This section is for those who prefer to do it in the terminal. End users can skip.

3.1 Initialize the repository

Enter the workspace

```
cd ~/.openclaw/workspace-curso-openclaw
```

Initialize git (if it doesn't exist yet)

```
git init
```

```
git branch -M main
```

Connect to the remote repository

```
git remote add origin https://github.com/SEU_USER/openclaw-backup.git
```

Configure user

```
git config user.name "Your Name"
```

```
git config user.email "your@email.com"
```

3.2 Create smart .gitignore

```
cat > .gitignore <<'EOF'
```

Never commit secrets or temporary data

```
*.env
```

```
*.key
```

```
*.pem
```

```
node_modules/
```

```
.DS_Store
```

```
__pycache__/
```

```
*.log
```

```
tmp/
```

```
EOF
```

3.3 Configure authentication with the token

Option 1: via URL (simpler)

```
git remote set-url origin https://ghp_YOUR_TOKEN@github.com/YOUR_USER/openclaw-backup
```

Option 2: via Git credential store

```
git config credential.helper store
```

On the first push operation, enter: user=YOUR_USER, password=YOUR_TOKEN

Option 3: via environment variable (more secure in scripts)

```
export GITHUB_TOKEN=$(op item get "GitHub PAT" --field credential --reveal)
```

3.4 First backup

```
git add -A
```

```
git commit -m "backup: initial - $(date '+%Y-%m-%d %H:%M')"
```

```
git push -u origin main
```

3.5 Backup script (save as backup.sh)

```
#!/bin/bash
```

```
set -e
```

```
WORKSPACE="$HOME/.openclaw/workspace-curso-openclaw"
```

```
DATE=$(date '+%Y-%m-%d %H:%M')
```

```
cd "$WORKSPACE"
```

```
git add -A
```

```
git diff --cached --quiet && echo "Nothing new to commit" && exit 0
```

```
git commit -m "backup: $DATE"
```

```
git push origin main
```

```
echo ". Backup completed: $DATE"
```

```
chmod +x backup.sh
```

3.6 Create cron via terminal

Edit crontab

crontab -e

Add line (every day at midnight)

0 0 * * * /root/.openclaw/workspace-curso-openclaw/backup.sh >> /tmp/backup.log 2>&1

Every day at 11 PM (UTC time = 8 PM Brasília)

0 20 * * * /root/.openclaw/workspace-curso-openclaw/backup.sh

4 · Backup Cron via OpenClaw (recommended)

OpenClaw has a native cron system. It's the most integrated way · the agent commits, pushes, and notifies you on Telegram.

How it works

You ask the agent to create the cron via chat. It schedules an isolated job that runs daily, does git add + commit + push, and sends a message confirming the backup.

· COMPLETE PROMPT TO CONFIGURE

Create a cron job to back up the workspace on GitHub every day at 11 PM Brasília time. The job should: git add everything, commit with today's date, push, and send me a message confirming. Use sessionTarget isolated and send the result here on Telegram.

· PROMPT · CHECK STATUS

List all active cron jobs and show me when the last backup was on GitHub

· PROMPT · VIEW EXECUTION HISTORY

Shows the history of the last 5 executions of the backup cron job

· PROMPT · RUN NOW

Runs the backup cron job now without waiting for the scheduled time

· PROMPT · PAUSE

Pauses the automatic backup cron job temporarily

· PROMPT · DELETE

Deletes the backup cron job from GitHub permanently

5 · Quick reference

Action

Terminal command

Repository status

git status

View differences

git diff

Commit everything

git add -A && git commit -m "message"

Push to GitHub

git push origin main

View history

git log --oneline -10

See what changed

git show HEAD

Revert to a commit

git checkout <hash> -- arquivo.md

Clone on new server

git clone [https://github.com/user/openclaw-](https://github.com/user/openclaw-backup)

backup ~/.openclaw/workspace

Useful cron expressions

When

Expression

Brasilia Time · UTC

Every day at midnight (BRT)

0 3 * * *

00:00 BRT = 03:00 UTC

Every day at 11 PM (BRT)

0 2 * * *

23:00 BRT = 02:00 UTC

Every day at 6 PM (BRT)

0 21 * * *

18:00 BRT = 21:00 UTC

Every 6 hours

0 */6 * * *

.

Every Monday at 9 AM (BRT)

0 12 * * 1

09:00 BRT = 12:00 UTC

6 · Migrate to a new server with the backup

If you need to change VPS or reinstall everything, the backup on GitHub guarantees that the agent returns exactly as it was.

· PROMPT TO MIGRATE

I just installed OpenClaw on a new server. Help me to restore the workspace from the backup in github.com/myuser/openclaw-backup

Manual steps

On the new server, after installing OpenClaw

```
git clone https://ghp_TOKEN@github.com/YOUR_USER/openclaw-backup.git \
~/openclaw/workspace-curso-openclaw
```

Verify that everything arrived

```
ls ~/openclaw/workspace-curso-openclaw/
```

```
cat ~/openclaw/workspace-curso-openclaw/MEMORY.md
```

· The agent will wake up with all memory intact · MEMORY.md,
context files, configurations.
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